CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

RADIATION THERAPIST IN THE AI ERA

Treatment planning is digital. Positioning a frightened patient exactly, every day, is still human precision work.

★ TL;DR — Median ~$75,000 with a 1–2 year study band through an accredited program, certification and state licensing. The catch: the work is emotionally serious and there is no tolerance for casual setup errors. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

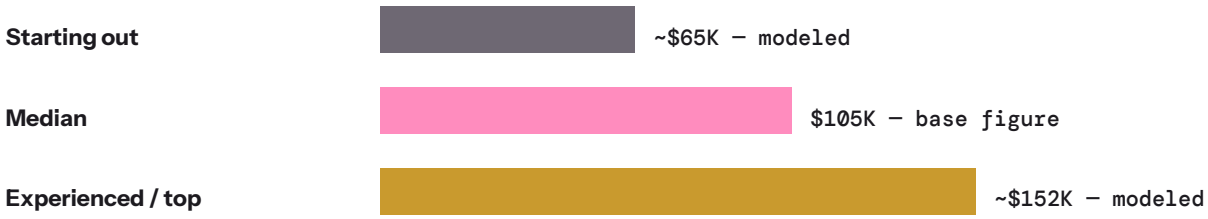
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$105K · TRAINING 1-2 years · AI RISK LOW · STATE LICENSE

- Cancer care gives the technical work obvious human meaning.
- AI helps planning, but identity checks and physical setup remain human safeguards.
- You will see the same patients repeatedly, which creates both connection and emotional weight.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Radiation Therapist is a ~$105K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A RADIATION THERAPIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Review the treatment plan and verify patient, site and setup

✓ Position and immobilize the patient for precise treatment delivery

✓ Use imaging to confirm alignment before operating treatment equipment

✓ Monitor response, document treatment and communicate concerns to the care team

Think: a precision operator inside a cancer-care team, trusted with both advanced equipment and a vulnerable person's daily experience.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI supports contouring, planning, image matching and record checks inside the treatment system.	Therapists still notice the wrong setup, a changed body, anxiety, pain or a detail that means stop and verify before treatment proceeds.

⚠ **This is not impersonal machine operation. Patients may be frightened, ill or deteriorating, and your accuracy and manner both become part of their care.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ A focused clinical specialty with advanced technology ✓ Repeated patient contact and a clear sense of purpose ✓ Structured treatment workflows inside a specialist team	✗ Emotional exposure to serious illness and loss ✗ Intense concentration on setup and verification every time ✗ Physical work positioning patients and equipment

Good fit? You are exact, compassionate and steady, with enough emotional discipline to care without becoming careless or detached.
Bad fit? You dislike hospitals, repetitive precision, serious illness or work where a small setup mistake matters greatly.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ACCREDITED RADIATION THERAPY PROGRAM	DOOR B — RADIOGRAPHER BRIDGE
Complete an accredited radiation therapy program with clinical education, pass the national certification examination and obtain state licensure where required.	Some accredited pathways build on an existing radiography credential and imaging experience. This can shorten the conceptual leap, but clinical competence in therapy still has to be earned.

Smart move: Choose clinical rotations for the treatment systems and patient mix you want to work with, and ask graduates where the program's students actually get hired.
Where you land after: Experienced radiation therapist, then senior therapist, educator, department leader or further study toward dosimetry and related specialties.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
UNDERSTAND THE	ENTER AN	BUILD CLINICAL	CERTIFY AND	START IN	DEEPEN YOUR

STEP 1 — Understand the real work

FREE · TODAY

- Research the treatment workflow, patient population and state licensing requirements.
- Speak with a radiation therapist about emotional load and daily pace.

STEP 2 — Enter an accredited program

STUDY · REQUIRED PATH

- Complete anatomy, physics, mathematics and patient-care prerequisites as required.
- Confirm the program leads to certification and licensure in your state.

STEP 3 — Build clinical precision

SUPERVISED · HANDS ON

- Master simulation, positioning, immobilization, imaging and treatment delivery.
- Practice independent verification habits before speed becomes the goal.

STEP 4 — Certify and license

REQUIRED · STATE GATE

- Pass the ARRT radiation therapy certification examination.
- Apply for the state license or authorization required to practice.

STEP 5 — Start in a supportive center

PAID · AFTER LICENSING

- Choose a department with strong orientation, case variety and safety culture.
- Learn each treatment system thoroughly rather than collecting superficial equipment names.

STEP 6 — Deepen your specialty EARNED · WITH EXPERIENCE

- Take complex sites, advanced techniques and quality responsibilities.
- Consider education, leadership or dosimetry preparation if you want a next step.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: map accredited programs, prerequisites and the license rules in your target state.
- □ Days 1–30: submit applications and begin closing science or mathematics gaps.
- □ Days 31–60: arrange observation or interviews so you understand the emotional and physical reality.
- □ Days 61–90: confirm clinical placements, funding and your expected certification timeline.
- □ Day 90: you should be admitted, enrolled or holding a firm start in the accredited pipeline.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **EXACT AIM. HUMAN CARE.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.